



Echidna

If you found an egg the size of a grape, you might wonder if a bird or reptile was going to hatch from it, and you might be surprised to see a mammal pop out! The curious echidna (eh-kid-na) is one of only two types of mammal to lay eggs – the other is the platypus. A mother echidna lays a single egg with a leathery shell, and keeps it warm in a pouch on her belly. Ten days later, a baby, called a puggle, hatches.

The short-beaked echidna has a jacket of spines that puts off predators from attacking it while it looks for food. It uses its strong claws to dig for its favourite tasty treats – ants and termites.

Short-beaked echidna,
New Guinea and Australia

